

LESSON 136 (0.5) Ground (2.0) Local Solo

Lesson Objective

The purpose of this lesson is to continue to enhance the applicant's confidence and abilities to operate the aircraft solo. During this lesson the applicant will practice normal and crosswind takeoffs and landings, slow flight, stalls, steep turns, and ground reference maneuvers.

Pre-Brief

- Local Solo Plan of Action
- Outline the objectives and completion standards of the lesson.
- Establish the student responsibilities.
- Review homework assigned in the previous lesson.
- Student questions.

Instructor Guidance

- This is an unsupervised local solo with practice area maneuvers — your pre-brief and go/no-go assessment are the only safeguards before releasing the student. Take the time to thoroughly evaluate weather conditions, the student's readiness, and their awareness of the plan of action before signing off.
- Verify the student's solo endorsement currency before every unsupervised solo flight. Per 14 CFR §61.87, the endorsement is valid for 90 calendar days. If expired or approaching expiration, re-endorse before the student departs. Also confirm that all other required documents are present, current, and valid before the student leaves.
- Review the student's TOLD card and weather briefing thoroughly before approving the go/no-go decision. The student must be making this decision based on a complete and accurate picture of the conditions — not a cursory check. If the briefing is incomplete or the TOLD card contains errors, send the student back to correct it before proceeding.
- Discuss the runways in use and pattern entry procedures before departure. Ask the student how they intend to enter the practice area and how they will transition back to the pattern — a student with a clear mental plan will manage their time and fuel more effectively.
- Stress the importance of making radio calls in the practice area and at any non-towered airports. Remind the student to announce "student pilot solo" on initial contact with ATC and when operating at non-towered airports on the CTAF. This is a safety practice that must not be omitted.
- Track the student's solo flight using FlightRadar24 or FlightAware for the entire duration of the flight. Confirm that the student is operating in the correct practice area and completing the required line items. Review the ground track during the post-brief to verify all line items were accomplished.

Lesson Content**Checklist Procedures**

- Student pilot solo.

Preflight Inspection

- Student pilot solo.

Operation of the Communications and Navigation Units

- Student pilot solo.

Engine Starting

- Student pilot solo.

Radio Communication Procedures and ATC Phraseology

- Student pilot solo.

Visual Scanning and Collision Avoidance

- Student pilot solo.

Taxiing

- Student pilot solo.

Normal and Crosswind Takeoff

- Student pilot solo.

Steep Turns

- Student pilot solo.

Maneuvering During Slow Flight

- Student pilot solo.

Stalls

- Student pilot solo.

Ground Reference Maneuvers

- Student pilot solo.

Traffic Patterns

- Student pilot solo.

Go-Arounds or Rejected Landings

- Student pilot solo.

Normal and Crosswind Landings

- Student pilot solo.

Postflight Procedures

- Ensure that the student conducts a thorough postflight inspection.

Post Brief

- Student self-critique.
- Review ground track to ensure student did all line items.
- Student questions.
- Logbook Completion.
- Schedule and preview next lesson.
- Assign Homework:
 - Review stage 2 material from lesson 131.

Completion Standards

This lesson is complete when the applicant can execute a local solo in accordance with all Florida Tech Aviation, FAA and local procedures and regulations.